

NEWS RELEASE

TANDY CORPORATION/RADIO SHACK

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT:
Martin B. Weinstein
Director of Publicity

(817) 390-3272

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SUBJECT:
TRS-80 Plug 'n Power

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

New Radio Shack TRS-80 Plug 'n Power™ Controller lets

TRS-80® computers command lights and appliances

Radio Shack, a division of Tandy Corporation, has introduced an inexpensive new device that permits direct computer control of up to 256 line-powered lights and appliances: the TRS-80 Plug 'n Power™ Controller (26-1182), \$ 39.95 at Radio Shack stores, Computer Centers and participating dealers.

The TRS-80 Plug 'n Power Controller connects to the cassette output of any TRS-80® Model I, Model III or Color Computer. It translates instructions from the host TRS-80 computer into controlling signals, which are coupled through normal AC power wiring to Plug 'n Power remote appliance and lamp dimmer modules (sold separately). Any one of up to 256 remote modules can be reached with a command to turn on, turn off, brighten or dim a light, or to turn an appliance on or off. Alternatively, a group of up to 16 remote modules can be turned on or off together, and up to sixteen such groups are accessible.

The TRS-80 Plug 'n Power Controller includes the software necessary to make use of its capabilities with a TRS-80 Model I Level I or II, Model III or Color Computer, plus programming advice. And since it plugs into the host

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computer's cassette connector, it comes equipped with an additional cassette connector and bypass switch to permit normal operation of the computer with a cassette recorder.

The TRS-80 Plug 'n Power Controller also permits use of the host TRS-80 computer's ability to keep track of the time of day. A precise real time clock built into the Controller sends accurate timekeeping signals ("ticks" of the clock, but faster and therefor more precise) to the host computer, where they update its time-of-day or elapsed time data. This allows commands to be executed either according to a preset time-of-day schedule, or, with appropriate user-provided software, according to an elapsed-time sequence. It is also possible to bypass the timekeeping criteria and enter direct commands via the computer keyboard, which are executed immediately.

Radio Shack stores and participating dealers offer a number of U.L.-listed remote modules which the TRS-80 Plug 'n Power Controller can command. These include a \$ 16.99 Appliance Module (61-2681), which can turn on or off a 15 Amp resistive load, a 1/3 HP motor or up to 500 Watts of incandescent lighting; a \$ 16.99 Lamp Dimmer Module (61-2682), which can turn on or off or brighten or dim up to 300 Watts of incandescent lighting; a \$ 17.99 Wall Switch Module (61-2683) which mounts in the place of a wall switch and can turn on or off or brighten or dim up to 500 Watts of incandescent lighting; and a \$ 17.99 Universal Appliance Module (61-2684) that can turn a television or similar appliance on or off at a three-prong grounded power outlet.

The TRS-80 Plug 'n Power Controller is U.L. approved. All Radio Shack Plug 'n Power products are designed for use with normal 110 Volt (nominal) household power wiring.

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